

NICOLÁS FUERTES SEGURA

CONTACT INFORMATION	3017 North Hall Department of Economics University of California Santa Barbara, CA 93106	<i>E-mail:</i> nfuertessegura@ucsb.edu <i>Website:</i> nicolasfuertessegura.github.io
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Labor Economics, Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics	
EDUCATION	University of California, Santa Barbara	
	Ph.D., Economics <i>Committee: Heather Royer (advisor), Kelly Bedard, David Silver</i>	Expected 2026
	M.A., Economics	2021
	Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá D.C, Colombia	
	M.A., Economics	2017
	B.A., Economics with minor in French Language and Culture	2015
WORKING PAPERS (ABSTRACTS AT END)	(Job Market Paper) “Friendship Formation and Network Effects: Experimental Evidence from Ecuador” with Yannú Cruz-Aguayo “The Impacts of Terrorist Attacks on Teenagers’ Socioemotional Skills and Risky Health Behaviors” (Preparing for submission) “The Asymmetric Effects of High Achiever Peers: Experimental Evidence from Ecuador” with Yannú Cruz-Aguayo and Carolina Echeverri (Preparing for submission) “Medium-Term Impacts of Access to Daycare on School Outcomes: Experimental Evidence from Rio de Janeiro” with Pedro Carneiro, Sofia Castro, Yannú Cruz-Aguayo, Gregory Elacqua and Norbert Schady	
WORK IN PROGRESS	“The Intergenerational Effects of Cigarette Taxes on Smoking” with Susana Otalvaro-Ramirez “The Impact of the Colombia’s Peace Agreement on Expectations and Aspirations”	
FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS	ASHEcon ”Health and Development” Program Chair Award	2025
	APPAM Equity & Inclusion Fellowship	2024
	Research Quarter Fellowship, UCSB	2024
	ASHEcon Diversity Scholarship	2023
	Gretler Fellowship, UCSB	2022
	Distinction in Ph.D. Preliminary Exam, Econometrics, UCSB	2021

RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

University of California Santa Barbara

Prof. Heather Royer

Summer 2022

Universidad de los Andes

Dr. Catherine Rodríguez & Prof. Adriana Camacho

2017

Renata Pardo, Lina Castaño & Prof. Raquel Bernal

2015 – 2017

Prof. Andrés Moya

2014 – 2015

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

University of California, Santa Barbara

Head Teaching Assistant

Economics 9 Introduction to Economics (Undergraduate)

F2025

Economics 2 Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)

F2023 - S2025

Teaching Assistant

Economics 101 Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)

W2022 - S2023

Economics 140A Introduction to Econometrics (Undergraduate)

F2022

Economics 1 Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

F2021 – S2022

Economics 10A Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate)

F2020 – S2021

Universidad de los Andes

Teaching Assistant

The Economics of Risky Health Behaviors (Graduate)

Summer 2017

Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)

S2015, S2017

Applied ELCA Research Seminar (Undergraduate)

F2015 – F2016

Measurement and Accounting (Undergraduate)

S2015 – F2016

PRESENTATIONS

2025 (schedule): APPAM, ASHEcon, LACEA Annual Conference, Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics, Western Economic Association Annual Conference, UCSB Applied Microeconomics Lunch

2024: APPAM(x2), ASHEcon, UCSB Applied Microeconomics Lunch

2023: Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics

WORK
EXPERIENCE

Inter-American Development Bank

Product External Consultant, Social
Protection and Labor Markets Division

Summer 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Consultant, Social Sector

2017 – 2020

Universidad de los Andes

Data Center Coordinator

2016 – 2017

REFEREEING

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy

SERVICE	Abstract Reviewer, ASHEcon Annual Conference	2024 – 2025
	Co-Chair of the Mentorship Program, UCSB	2022 – 2025
	Mentor for First-Year Economics Ph.D. Students, UCSB	2021 – 2025
	Organizing Committee Member for the Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics	2021 – 2024
AFFILIATIONS	American Economic Association	
	American Society of Health Economists	
	Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management	
	LACEA	
	Graduate Student Fellow, Broom Center for Demography, UCSB	
OTHER	<i>Programming:</i> STATA, L ^A T _E X, R, Matlab	
SKILLS	<i>Languages:</i> Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Portuguese (basic)	
PERSONAL	Colombian Citizen	
REFERENCES	Heather Royer (<i>advisor</i>)	Kelly Bedard
	Professor	Professor
	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
	heather.royer@ucsb.edu	kelly.bedard@ucsb.edu
	David Silver	
	Assistant Professor	
	Department of Economics	
	dsilver@ucsb.edu	
PLACEMENT OFFICERS	Placement Director	Placement Administrator
	Daniel Martin	Mark Patterson
	Associate Professor	Graduate Program Coordinator
	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
	danielmartin@ucsb.edu	grad@econ.ucsb.edu
WORKING PAPERS (ABSTRACTS)	(Job Market Paper) “Friendship Formation and Network Effects: Experimental Evidence from Ecuador” with Yyannú Cruz-Aguayo We study the impact of friendship networks on cognitive and non-cognitive skills using a unique randomized experiment from Ecuador. In each school, students are randomly assigned to classrooms in every grade from Kindergarten to 6th. We find that classroom exposure positively affect the probability that a friendship link forms in third grade and persists to sixth grade. We find that being randomly assigned to a classroom with more friends reduces scores in math and executive function among male students. Furthermore, we find that the negative effects are driven by the disruptive friends in the classroom. Finally, symptoms of depression are lower among students randomly assigned with more classroom friends, suggesting that the effects likely operate through a distraction or lack of attention channel.	

“The Impacts of Terrorist Attacks on Teenagers’ Socioemotional Skills and Risky Health Behaviors” (Preparing for submission)

This paper explores the impact of exposure to violence during childhood (0-9 years old) on socioemotional skills and risky health behaviors in adolescence. Using data from the Colombian Longitudinal Survey and municipality-level administrative data, I exploit the within-municipality cross-cohort variation of terrorist attacks among teenagers living in urban areas of Colombia. I find robust evidence that exposure to terrorist attacks is associated with a 0.046 SD increase in socioemotional difficulties experienced, mainly driven by increased hyperactivity, and a 6.5% increase in the probability of drinking. These results highlight the potential consequences of violence on new outcomes related to adolescent health.

“The Asymmetric Effects of High Achiever Peers: Experimental Evidence from Ecuador” with Yyannú Cruz-Aguayo and Carolina Echeverri (Preparing for submission)

We study the impact of exposure to high achievers on cognitive and non-cognitive skills using a unique randomized experiment from Ecuador. In each school, students are randomly assigned to classrooms in every grade from Kindergarten to 6th. We find that exposure to high achievers reduces test scores in math and executive function. Moreover, male students affect only males, and female students affect only females, consistent with homophily. Peer effects are intensified among top-performing students and students in smaller schools. Effects of 1st-grade peers are stronger but fade over time. Finally, we find reductions in self-reported happiness.

“Medium-Term Impacts of Access to Daycare on School Outcomes: Experimental Evidence from Rio de Janeiro” with Pedro Carneiro, Sofia Castro, Yyannú Cruz-Aguayo, Gregory Elacqua and Norbert Schady

In this document, we analyze the impacts of a large-scale intervention that provided access to daycare centers for children in low-income neighborhoods in the city of Rio de Janeiro. Our results suggest that the intervention had a positive impact on enrollment rates and on the number of years children were enrolled to daycare during early childhood. We also find that winning the lottery had a positive effect on how regularly children attended primary school during the academic year. Because of the high attrition rates in the sample, we are unable to conclude whether the lottery had a positive impact on medium-term academic outcomes like standardized tests scores and overall grades.